Wimbledon Boss Jokes Military Guards Would 'Sort Out' Disruptive Influencers

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Wimbledon's chief executive joked that Royal Marine commandos who help secure the famous tennis tournament would love to "sort out" social media **influencers** who disrupt matcheswhile still saying **influencers** matter for modern marketing.

The comments follow a debate that began at the U.S. Open, where organizers **accredited** about 100 **influencers** and content creators. A photo shoot during a Naomi Osaka match interrupted play and sparked talk about tennis **etiquette**. World No. 4 Coco Gauff said welcoming new fans is important but people should "follow the **etiquette** of the sport."

Speaking on a panel at Leaders Week London, Wimbledon boss Atkinson said the club does not have an official "influencer" accreditation category. Brand partners such as Polo Ralph Lauren may bring creators, he said, but they would be "tightly **chaperoned**." He praised SW19's tradition of fans quietly respecting the actionwhat he called a "self-policing" crowd.

Atkinson contrasted the U.S. Open's lively New York atmosphere, where someone with a ticket might start broadcasting mid-match with **ring lights**, with Wimbledon's stricter mood. Fans will not be allowed to bring portable **ring lights** to the **All England Club**. Still, he called a total ban on **influencers** "nonsense" because marketing now goes far beyond newspapers and TV.

"You've got to sort it out in a Wimbledon way," he said, keeping the tournament's brand and "magic" while adapting to new media. The joke about military security underscored how seriously Wimbledon wants calm courtseven as it courts online creators carefully.

Word Treasure

influencers -- Social media creators who share content and can shape what fans notice or buy.

etiquette -- Expected polite behavior, such as staying quiet during a tennis point.

accredited -- Officially approved to enter an event with special media or creator passes.

chaperoned -- Closely supervised so people follow the rules.

ring lights -- Circular lights content creators use to brighten their faces on camera.

All England Club -- The tennis club in London that hosts the Wimbledon Championships.

Background you need

Wimbledon is a famous tennis championship known for quiet crowds and strict traditions.

Social media influencers create online videos and photos that can promote events--or distract from play.

Tennis etiquette asks fans to stay still and silent during points.

Tournament organizers balance welcoming new audiences with protecting the match atmosphere.

Break it down

LEAD: Wimbledon CEO jokes military security would stop disruptive influencers
KEY EVENT: Comments after U.S. Open photo-shoot interruption debate
+- PLAYER VIEW: Coco Gauff welcomes new fans but wants etiquette
+- POLICY: No official influencer category; partners' creators chaperoned
RULES: No portable ring lights; self-policing quiet crowd tradition
BALANCE: Influencers matter for marketing but must fit Wimbledon's brand
OPEN QUESTION: How strictly new creator rules will be enforced

Why it matters

Sports events are adapting to social media while protecting fair play. Kids can discuss how online fame and real-world manners should share the same space.

Test what you remember

1. Which tournament's boss joked about sorting out influencers?

(A) The Super Bowl only
(B) Wimbledon
(C) A chess club picnic
(D) A spelling bee

2. What disrupted a Naomi Osaka match at the U.S. Open?

(A) A power outage on the Moon
(B) A missing tennis net forever
(C) A sudden snowstorm indoors
(D) A group of influencers doing a photo shoot

3. What did Coco Gauff say fans should follow?

(A) No rules at all
(B) Only loud music rules
(C) The etiquette of the sport
(D) Cooking recipes

4. What item will fans not be allowed to bring to Wimbledon?

(A) Water bottles of any kind ever
(B) Hats
(C) Shoes
(D) Portable ring lights

5. How does Atkinson say brand influencers would be handled?

(A) Given free run of the courts mid-point
(B) Banned from all of London
(C) Made the umpires
(D) Tightly chaperoned

6. Did Atkinson support a total influencer ban?

(A) Yes; forever with no marketing
(B) No; he called a total ban nonsense
(C) He banned all tennis
(D) He cancelled Wimbledon

Answer key (try the quiz first!): 1: B 2: D 3: C 4: D 5: D 6: B

Questions to think about

1. Atkinson (Wimbledon boss): Jokes security would sort out mid-match broadcasters; says influencers need control but a total ban is nonsense.

2. Coco Gauff: Says welcoming a new demographic matters if people follow tennis etiquette.

MY THOUGHTS (at least 20 words):